

Choosing the Window Manager

Windows may give you screensavers and themes. But Linux goes a step ahead and bundles entire window managers with the different configurations possible in each window manager. Different window managers are normally bundled with different distributions and if your distribution doesn't come with it, you can always download them. The window manager you use also depends on the desktop environment you have—KDE or Gnome.

For instance, Sawfish works only with Gnome, rather window managers built with GTK will work only in Gnome. Here are some of the popular window managers for Linux. You can get more information on window managers from www.plig.org/xwinman.

Fvwm: Want to experiment with a basic window manager first? Then you can start with Fvwm. Fvwm lets you launch programs from a menu that pops up when you click on any blank area on the desktop.

You even have a customisable button known as GoodStuff in which you can add the programs that you want to launch. Fvwm can be quite a useful win-

dow manager, especially if you are low on system resources and want more speed than features.

Fvwm95: Want the Microsoft Windows feel with Fvwm? Then you had better shift to Fvwm95, which is configured to look like Windows 95. So you get back



Linux gives you many window managers

the look and feel of the Start menu. You can add or remove the contents of the Start menu by editing the fvwm95 configuration file, but unlike Windows, you do not have the option of dragging and dropping files on the desktop.

AfterStep: Afterstep's look and feel is largely based on the Nextstep desktop (from the erstwhile NeXT OS). Afterstep

adds a certain glamour to the desktop environment with beep sounds and animations when you click on a functional icon such as minimise or maximise. You can configure most of the properties of Afterstep, such as its look and feel, through the pop-up menu. However, if you want to add files to the menu, you cannot get away without editing the configuration file. There are other features too such as controlling mouse speed. So, if you like heavy graphics and animation, AfterStep is the window manager to go in for.

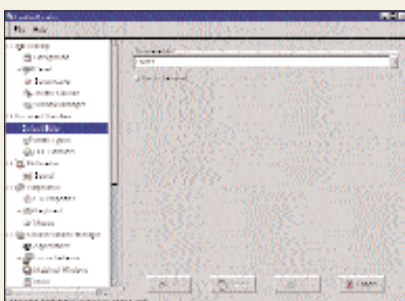
Enlightenment: Configuration, customisation, flexibility. If these are the key factors you are looking for, then you'll like Enlightenment. With this window manager, not only can you apply different colour combinations and styles, but also design your own template if you wish. Here too there are a number of graphical utilities such as borders and beeps to enhance your desktop. A graphical interface allows you to configure the various themes or switch between them. Enlightenment combined with the Gnome desktop environment makes for a good choice.

use a tool known as guichooser that lists all the window managers, and lets you select the one you want.



Handling your documents

If you want to change the way certain



Changing your default editor in Gnome

file types are viewed, edited or manipulated, you can do so from the Document Handlers section in the Gnome Control Center. The Default Editor option, for instance, will allow you to specify your default editor while working with text of any sort. When you click on files associated with editing or text, the selected editor will open up automatically.



Working with different browsers

Given the different type of application-URLs or file-associations, you can specify which browser will handle the URL through the URL Handlers option in Gnome Control Center. You can specify the default browser for a Web page, or for

ghelp that is used for all Gnome documentation and by default opens in Nautilus (Gnome File Manager and help browser).

The ghelp URL is usually used for documentation, and there are also URLs associated with man pages that also get opened in Nautilus. You can change the browser for any of these types of URLs by changing the browser in the handler textbox and clicking on the Set button.



Selecting themes in Gnome

You can work with different themes for your window manager using the Theme Selector caplet. The GTK themes that you get are settings that allow you to

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